

## Young explorer

As it grows, the young lemon shark begins to explore deeper waters but always returns to the mangrove forests. After around seven to eight years, the lemon shark leaves the mangroves for good.

### See also

Read about dolphins (116–117), who are air-breathing mammals that, like lemon sharks, give birth to live young.

## Hanging out

The pups must learn to hunt, or they will starve. They form friendship groups, hanging out with other pups and learning survival skills from each other.

## Take cover!

The lemon shark pup swims into the mangrove forests, where the trees' underwater roots and trunks will hide it from predators.

**Orbicular batfish** Like lemon shark pups, young orbicular batfish also seek safety in mangroves. As they drift in the water, these rusty-brown fish mimic dead leaves to avoid the attention of predators.



**Mudskipper** A common mangrove fish, the mudskipper breeds in burrows. The female leaves after laying her eggs, but the male stays to guard the burrow against animals that might try to sneak in and gobble up the eggs.

